

following columns:

ISIN	No. of units	NAV	Current value
INF189A01038	500	To get from navtable	= <A2> * <B2>

Ideally, Calc should have had a function to select the NAV from the *navtable* using the ISIN value as the key. Unfortunately, that is not possible.

The simplest option appears to be to use a Pivot Table.

So, after opening your spreadsheet, take the following steps:

1. Insert the Pivot Table.
2. Select *Data Source* registered with LibreOffice.
3. Choose NAVDB that you had registered above and the table *navdb.navtable*.
4. After a while, you will be asked to select the fields for the Pivot Table layout. Select both *isin* and *nav* as row fields. It will create a new sheet with the values. For the sake of simplicity, rename the sheet as 'Pivot'.

Now, go back to your primary sheet and define a

lookup function in the NAV column. For example, for the second row, it will be:

=VLOOKUP(A2, Pivot.A:B, 2)

This function will search for the value in A2 in the first column of the A and B columns of the Pivot sheet.

The process of using Base turned out to be a lot more complex than I had anticipated. However, the same complexity also suggests that using a spreadsheet as a front-end to a database is a very attractive option for decision taking, especially knowing how often one suffers trying to understand the unexpected results only to find that a value in some cell had been accidentally modified! 

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The author has earned the right to do what interests him. You can find him online at <http://sethanil.com>, <http://sethanil.blogspot.com>, and reach him via email at anil@sethanil.com.

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